

Thinking logically

Try these puzzles to find out if you're good at numerical and logical thinking. Allow about 30 minutes for the number puzzles (watch out for the trick questions) and take as long as you want on the logic puzzles. See pages 220–221 to find out more about different types of intelligence.

Number puzzles

1 A man has 14 camels and all but three die. How many are left?

2 The sum of all numbers from 1 to 7 is

a) 8 b) 15 c) 22 d) 25 e) 28

3 The day after tomorrow is two days before Tuesday. What day is it today?

a) Friday
b) Saturday
c) Sunday
d) Monday
e) Tuesday

4 What number comes next in the following sequence?

1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13...

a) 15 b) 17 c) 19 d) 21 e) 23

5 If two cooks can peel two potatoes in one minute, how many cooks will it take to peel 20 potatoes in 10 minutes?

a) 1 b) 2 c) 3 d) 4 e) 5

6 How many birthdays does the average man have?

7 A man lives next to a circular park. It takes him 80 minutes to walk around it in a clockwise direction but 1 hour 20 minutes to walk the other direction. Why?

8 Brian and Graham collect 30 snails in a garden. Brian found five times more snails than Graham. How many snails did Graham find?

a) 6 b) 8 c) 3 d) 0 e) 5

9 You're running a race and you overtake the person in second place. What place are you in now?

a) last b) 4th c) 3rd d) 2nd e) 1st

10 Janet is taller than Penny, and Claire is shorter than Janet. Which of the following statements is correct?

a) Claire is taller than Penny.
b) Claire is shorter than Penny.
c) Claire is as tall as Penny.
d) It's impossible to tell.
e) Claire is Penny's sister.

11 A group of ducks are walking in a line. There are two ducks in front of a duck, two ducks behind a duck, and a duck in the middle. How many ducks are there?

a) 1 b) 2 c) 3 d) 4 e) 5

12 What number is one half of one quarter of one tenth of 800?

a) 2 b) 5 c) 8 d) 10 e) 40

13 There are 30 crows in a field. The farmer shoots four. How many crows are in the field now?

14 Brad is four years old and his sister Celine is three times older. When Brad is 12 years old, how old will Celine be?

a) 16 b) 20 c) 24 d) 28 e) 36

15 What number comes next in the following sequence?

144, 121, 100, 81, 64...

a) 55 b) 49 c) 36 d) 16 e) 9

16 How many animals of each sex did Moses take on the Ark?

17 If there are three pizzas and you take away two, how many pizzas do you have?

18 If you have three sweets and you eat one every half hour, how long will they last?